

NETWORK LEAKS · INVESTIGATIVE DOSSIER · 01

The Private Parallel

What one Silicon Valley fortune actually funds in South Africa, and how it came to look so much like the aid agency the Trump administration shut down at the same time.



SCAN TO OPEN INTERACTIVE MAP
`altafrikaner.github.io`
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Sixteen organisations. Two decades.
Forty entities. Sixty-plus sources.

BY · ALT AFRIKANER

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Long-form investigative report · Approximately 6,000 words

Executive Finding

Thesis

This report documents a coordinated private philanthropic architecture financed by Pierre and Pam Omidyar that has, since 2004, funded fields substantially overlapping with those historically supported by the United States Agency for International Development (USAID). When the Trump administration dismantled USAID between January and July 2025, that private architecture continued to fund the same organisations, in the same countries, on parallel tracks. The report does not claim that the Omidyar network is USAID, that it operates on behalf of the United States government, or that a central authority directs its constituent organisations. It documents functional overlap. In several documented cases, that overlap was direct.

Three documented public-private intersections

Case 1 — Making All Voices Count (2013 to 2017). USAID, the United Kingdom Department for International Development (DFID), the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (Sida), and Omidyar Network were the four named donors to the same programme, which issued 178 grants across twelve or more countries.

Case 2 — Open Government Partnership (OGP, 2022 budget). Approximately USD 800,000 from USAID and USD 600,000 from Luminate appear side by side on the same disclosed donor list. Luminate's cumulative disclosed support to OGP across 2013 to 2024 totals approximately USD 7.365 million.

Case 3 — Trust, Accountability and Inclusion Collaborative (TAI). A donor-coordination structure whose members include Luminate, Ford, Hewlett, MacArthur, Open Society Foundations, Packard, Skoll and Chandler, and which formally lists USAID and the UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO) as observers. Tracks more than USD 500 million in active grants.

Four explicit non-claims

Non-claim 1. This report does not claim that Pierre or Pam Omidyar personally directed the Episcopal Church's May 2025 refusal to help resettle Afrikaner refugees.

Non-claim 2. This report does not claim that Democracy Fund grants to Church World Service and the International Refugee Assistance Project were earmarked for *Pacito v. Trump* or its April 2026 amendment challenging the Afrikaner-refugee preference specifically.

Non-claim 3. This report does not claim that Luminate directed any Real411, Media Monitoring Africa or Meta moderation outcome, or that Luminate funding controls National Treasury or DBSA municipal-finance decisions.

Non-claim 4. This report does not claim that the Omidyar Group was operationally involved in either of the two 2025 Nairobi-connected refugee operations, and it does not accuse any individual or organisation named of unlawful conduct.

Infrastructure and act are two different things. Infrastructure is what the record shows. Acts are what the record does not show. This report describes the first and does not invent the second.

In 1980, thirteen-year-old Pierre Omidyar enrolled at St Andrew's Episcopal School in Potomac, Maryland, an institution within the Episcopal Diocese of Washington. Forty-five years later, the Episcopal Church declined a federal request to participate in resettling Afrikaner refugees after Presiding Bishop Sean Rowe consulted Anglican Archbishop Thabo Makgoba of Cape Town.

Between those two dates, Pierre Omidyar became one of the richest men in the world. His family foundation donated approximately USD 625,000²¹ back to St Andrew's. The Omidyar network funded the wider institutional life of the Anglican Communion through half a dozen channels. And, at the same time as the United States Agency for International Development (USAID) was being dismantled by the Trump administration in 2025, that private philanthropic architecture kept operating on parallel tracks. This report is about what that architecture does, whom it funds, and where its money touches a South African election, a Johannesburg raid or a Washington courtroom.

None of what follows is a claim of a conspiracy. Everything below is on the public record. Grant filings, tax returns, board pages, corporate filings from London, Estonia and Tel Aviv, statements by clergy, court dockets, and reports issued by the Electoral Commission of South Africa. Where a document exists, it is cited. Where a link cannot be drawn, that is stated in as many words. The reader is left, at the end, to draw the conclusion the reader finds best supported by the evidence.

The eBay man and his sixteen instruments

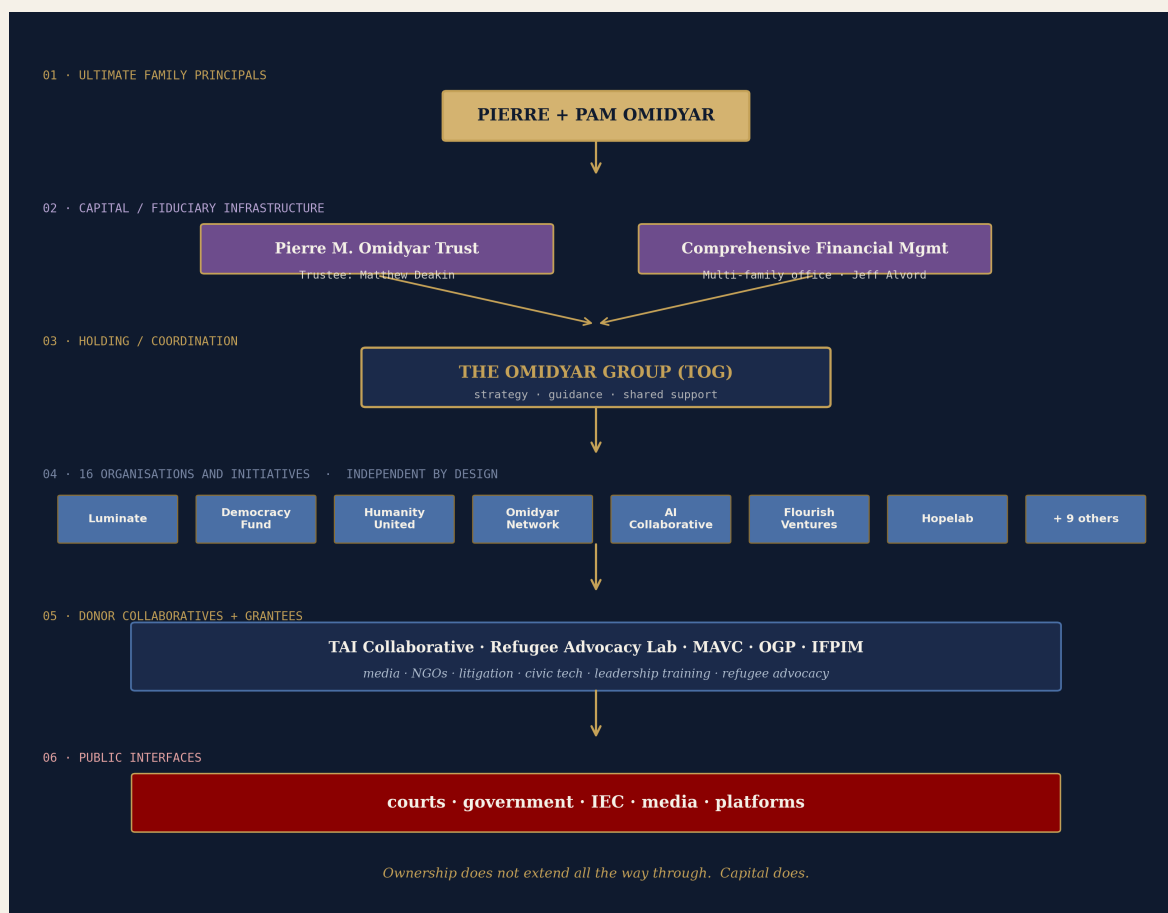
Pierre Omidyar founded eBay in September 1995 out of a personal website he was running at the time. He was twenty-eight. He held on to a large stake through the company's 1998 initial public offering. By 1999 he was worth several billion dollars. Since 2004 he and his wife Pam have deployed above USD 1.5 billion of that fortune through a coordinated group of philanthropic, investment, media and civic-technology organisations. They call it, publicly, the Omidyar Group. It currently lists sixteen constituent organisations and initiatives: AI Collaborative, Democracy Fund, Flourish Ventures, Hawai'i Data Collaborative, Hawai'i Leadership Forum, Honolulu Civil Beat, Hopelab, Humanity United, Imaginable Futures, Luminate, Omidyar Network, Public First, Spero Ventures, Topic Studios (which houses First Look Media, the Intercept's original parent), Ulupono Initiative, and Working Capital.

The Group describes those sixteen bodies as "independent by design." That phrase is not a decoration. It means that each of them has its own leadership, its own board, and its own operating priorities. The Group's public materials say it provides them with governance and guidance, strategic frameworks, communications and policy support, research and analysis, and financial and investment guidance, while its constituent organisations operate independently. In plain English, family capital underwrites the wider architecture, shared infrastructure and strategic direction, while the individual operating organisations retain their own boards and grantmaking decisions. That distinction matters when the phone starts ringing.

Above those sixteen bodies sits an ordinary layer of capital and fiduciary infrastructure, of the sort any wealthy family in the United States would maintain. The Pierre M. Omidyar Trust, whose trustee is a lawyer called Matthew Deakin⁴, is named in United States Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) filings as the ultimate beneficial owner of some of the family's technology-investment vehicles. A man called Jeff Alvord³ is publicly described in Luminate's own staff biography as Managing Director of the Omidyar Group. His job, in his own biography, is to oversee financial management and the flow of resources to the Group's constituent entities. He is separately described as an adviser and agent for the Omidyar family and as manager of Comprehensive Financial Management, a multi-family office. United Kingdom Companies House currently lists Pierre Omidyar, Jeff Alvord and Matthew Deakin together as persons with significant control over Luminate UK Services Limited, the London vehicle through which much of Luminate's African grantmaking passes.

Nobody stands above Pierre and Pam Omidyar as principals. Naming Alvord and Deakin is not an attempt to imply hidden authority. It is a description of the ordinary architecture through which a fortune of that size is legally organised before it reaches its programmatic vehicles. The point of the description is that when a reader hears "the Omidyar network funded X," the sentence describes a real, mapped chain of ownership and control, not a rumour.

The public face of that chain changed in March 2026. Michele L. Jawando, an American civic-tech lawyer, was promoted from President to Chief Executive Officer of Omidyar Network⁵. She had joined in 2023 after a career at Google and the Center for American Progress. Her elevation matters because Omidyar Network Fund, the group's principal 501(c)(3) charitable foundation, held approximately USD 367.6 million² in assets as of its most recent Internal Revenue Service (IRS) Form 990 filing. Jawando now runs it.



Hierarchy of the Omidyar architecture. Ultimate principals at the top, capital and fiduciary infrastructure below them, the Omidyar Group as coordinator, sixteen independent operating organisations below that, then donor collaboratives and grantees, then public interfaces.

What USAID did, and what it looked like when USAID stopped

For sixty-four years, from 1961 to mid-2025, USAID administered tens of billions of dollars a year in foreign assistance across roughly one hundred and thirty countries. It funded rural electrification and school textbooks. It also funded, across every continent, the kind of civic-society infrastructure the phrase "democracy assistance" describes: local newsrooms, election observation missions, human-rights non-governmental organisations (NGOs), judicial-training programmes, fact-checkers, refugee-resettlement agencies. Its funding decisions were publicly filed. Its grantees were named on its website. Its budget was set by Congress. Its documents were subject to the Freedom of Information Act (FOIA). It had many defenders and many critics, but on one point everyone agreed: whatever USAID did, it did through public appropriations, federal contracting and assistance mechanisms, and formal oversight requirements.

The Trump administration dismantled USAID in early 2025 and transferred what remained of its foreign-assistance functions into the State Department, with the formal transfer beginning on 1 July 2025. According to USAID's own Office of Inspector General, more than a thousand awards, representing approximately USD 45 billion in development and humanitarian commitments, were transferred. Personnel were laid off. Many awards were terminated, paused or transferred.

The organisations USAID had funded did not stop working. They were still, in mid-2025, publishing election-fact-checks in Johannesburg, litigating refugee cases in Washington, monitoring Meta's African moderation queue, training the next generation of East African political leaders, and running a public-facing platform used by 257 South African municipalities¹³. They were still working because the private philanthropic sector, of which the Omidyar Group is one of the largest and most globally coordinated members, had been funding the same fields on parallel tracks for two decades already. The dismantling of USAID in 2025 did not create the private parallel. It made the private parallel visible.

The reason a comparison between USAID and the Omidyar network is defensible on the public record is not that anyone can prove common command. Nobody can. The comparison is defensible because in at least three well-documented cases, USAID and the Omidyar network sat inside the same programme.

Case one: Making All Voices Count

Between 2013 and 2017, a joint programme called Making All Voices Count (MAVC) issued 178 grants across twelve or more countries⁷, including South Africa, Kenya, Ghana, Nigeria, Mozambique, Uganda, Tanzania, Indonesia and the Philippines. It funded civic technology, citizen engagement, inclusive governance, transparency and government accountability. Its official donors were four: USAID, the United Kingdom's Department for International Development (DFID, which was later folded into what is now the Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office, or FCDO), the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (Sida), and Omidyar Network.

Not similar programmes. Not adjacent organisations. The same programme. Same brochure. Same grant lifecycle. 178 grants across the same twelve countries.

Case two: The Open Government Partnership

The Open Government Partnership (OGP) is a global multilateral initiative launched in 2011 that commits its member states to open and citizen-responsive governance. Its 2022 disclosed budget included direct funding of roughly USD 800,000 from USAID, USD 1.4 million from the Open Society Foundations (OSF), USD 1 million from the Hewlett Foundation, USD 700,000 from the Ford Foundation, and USD 600,000 from Luminate. Government funders and private-foundation funders side by side, on the same funder list of the same governance institution⁸.

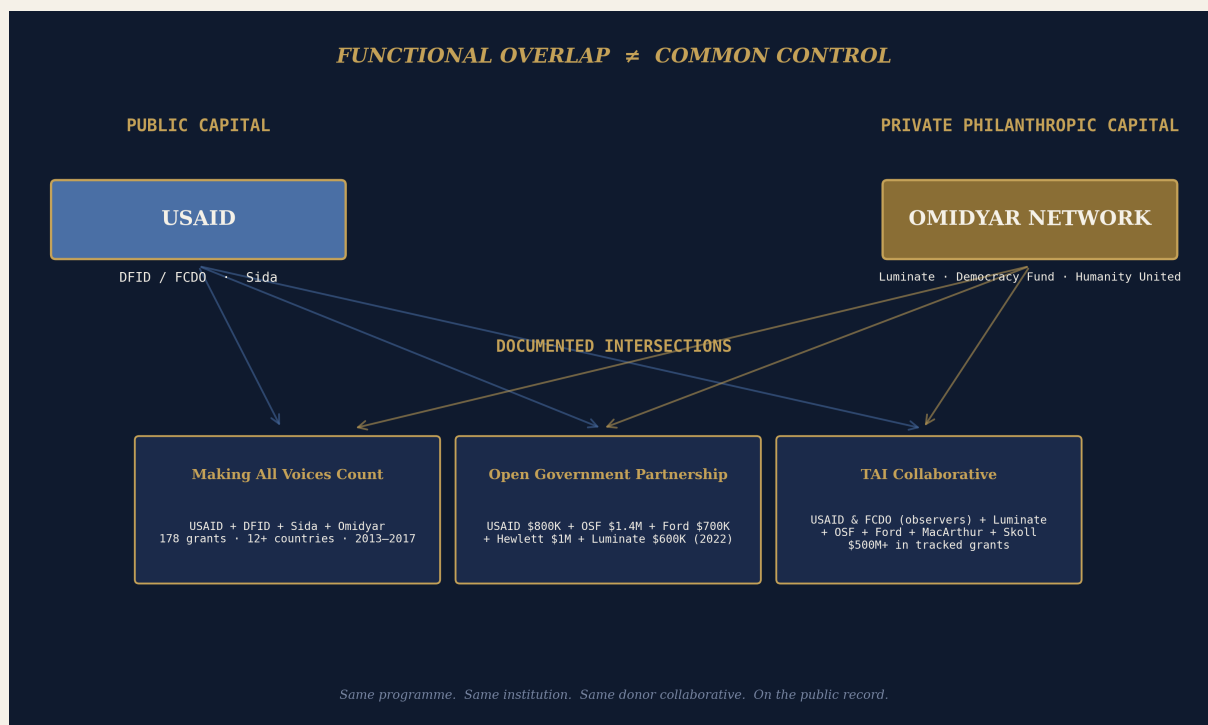
Luminate's cumulative disclosed support to OGP has been USD 1 million (2013 to 2016), USD 3.8 million (2016 to 2019), USD 1.565 million (2020 to 2021) and USD 1 million (2022 to 2024). Roughly USD 7.365 million over eleven years⁸. That is not a phase. That is a relationship.

Case three: The Trust, Accountability and Inclusion Collaborative

The Trust, Accountability and Inclusion Collaborative · Funders for Participatory Governance, previously known as the Transparency and Accountability Initiative and now called TAI, is a donor-coordination platform for grantmakers active in transparency and accountability. TAI's own public materials say its members "strategize, interrogate evidence, develop joint actions, share knowledge, build alliances and align funding." Members include Luminate, Ford, Hewlett, MacArthur, OSF, Packard, Skoll and Chandler. TAI has formally included USAID and FCDO in its donor network; its 2024 reporting described both government agencies as observers alongside the private philanthropic members. Its funding database tracks more than USD 500 million in active transparency and accountability grants⁹.

The pattern across the three cases is neither identical nor accidental. MAVC was true co-funding of a single programme. OGP is co-funding of a single institution. TAI is shared participation in a donor-coordination structure. Three different forms of overlap. All three documented on the record. All three placing USAID and the Omidyar network's principal grantmaking arms inside the same governance infrastructure, at the same time, for years.

The point is not that the two sides are the same. The point is that they have never, in this century, operated in isolation from one another.



Public capital and private philanthropic capital meeting inside the same three documented governance-infrastructure vehicles. Not a claim of common command. A description of documented overlap.

What Luminate says it is trying to do

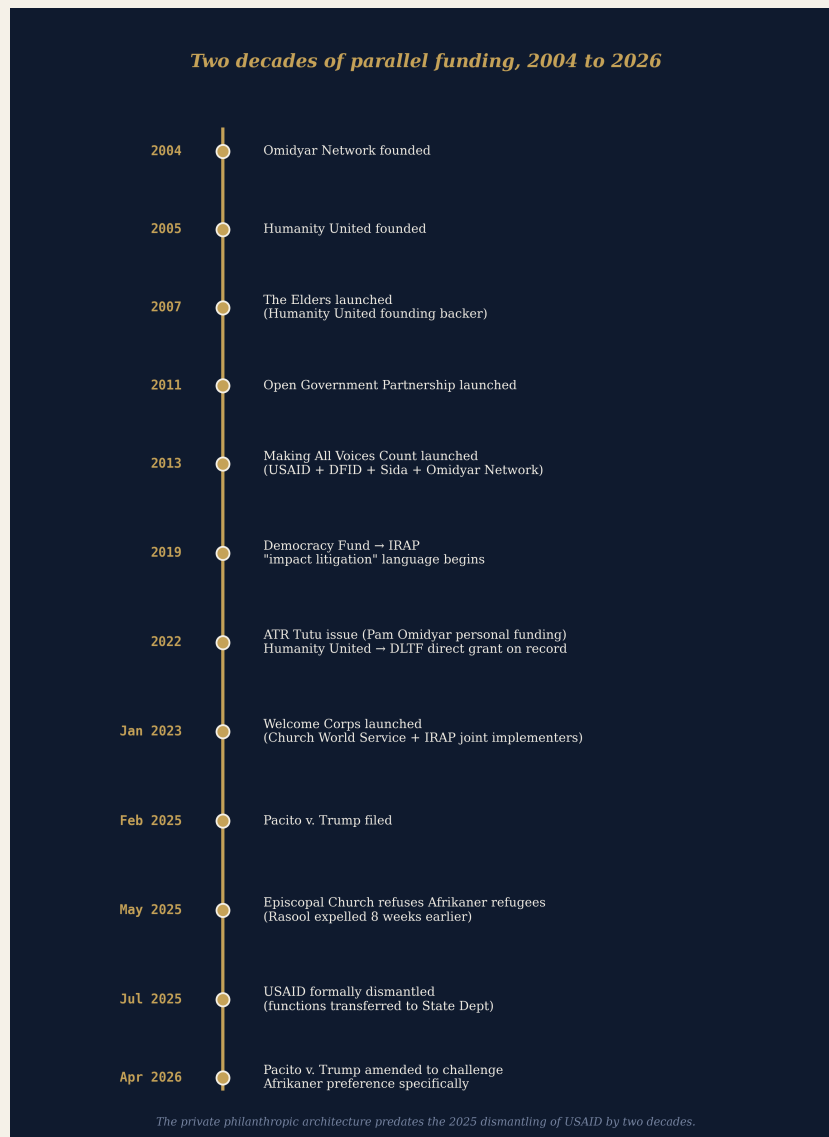
Before mapping what Luminate's money does inside South Africa, it is worth quoting what Luminate says it is trying to accomplish. Its published 2022 to 2027 strategy is on its own website. The language it uses to describe its own work is more direct than any characterisation this report could offer.

Luminate says it works, globally, to change the "rules of the game," including international norms, funding flows and global governance mechanisms. Its Strategic Initiatives division is organised into four explicit workstreams: Policy, Campaigns and Media, Litigation, and Ecosystems and Partnerships. Its stated objective for the digital public sphere includes "setting and enforcing rules and standards"¹⁰.

This is not Alt Afrikaner inferring what a funder wants to accomplish from the pattern of its grants. This is Luminate stating, publicly, on its own website, what it wants to accomplish, and how it has organised itself to accomplish it. The reason it matters is that those four workstreams describe, almost line for line, the traditional functions of a public foreign-assistance agency. Policy influence. Media influence. Strategic litigation. Ecosystem-building through partnerships. If a reader were handed the four workstream headings above without the Luminate letterhead, and asked to identify the institution, USAID would be a natural guess.

The overlap between the two lists is set out below.

This does not establish that Luminate is USAID, or that Luminate operates on behalf of any government. It establishes that the private philanthropic architecture this report describes has, on its own account, organised itself around the four operational functions traditionally associated with a public foreign-assistance agency. The reader should keep that self-description in mind while reading the next section, which is about what those four workstreams have funded inside South Africa.



Two decades of parallel philanthropic funding across the same institutional space as government foreign-assistance. The private architecture predates the 2025 dismantling of USAID by almost twenty years.

USAID historical function	Laminar stated workstream
Policy dialogue with partner-country governments and multilaterals	Policy
Support for independent media and information environments	Campaigns and Media
Legal reform, rule-of-law programming and public-interest litigation support	Litigation
Grants management, donor coordination, coalition-building with peer funders	Ecosystems and Partnerships

What the Omidyar money actually does inside South Africa

South Africans encounter the Omidyar money through a shortlist of organisations. Media Monitoring Africa (MMA), which rebranded to Moxii Africa in January 2026, publishes ethical-journalism programme work and, more consequentially, owns and operates Real411, the digital-disinformation reporting platform. Luminate's tax filings disclose grants of USD 150,000 to MMA in 2021 and USD 150,000 in 2022, totalling USD 300,000 in disclosed direct support across those two years¹¹.

During the May 2024 South African elections, Real411 was designated the official platform for reporting election-related disinformation. Its independent assessments were shared with the Electoral Commission's Directorate for Electoral Offences. The Electoral Commission's own 2024 National and Provincial Elections Report records that 289 election-related complaints ran through Real411¹², and that more than half of the adjudicated complaints were upheld as misinformation or disinformation.

The precise pipeline matters. A public complaint enters Real411. A Digital Complaints Committee of legal, media and digital experts assesses it. The committee has no legally binding power. Its independent assessment is then referred to the Electoral Commission's Directorate for Electoral Offences, which may or may not act. Africa Check operates in the adjacent information-integrity ecosystem, and its work is often visible in the same public conversation, but Africa Check is not, on the documented record, a mandatory serial stage inside the Real411 referral chain. It is important to say what the pipeline actually is rather than what it might be, because otherwise the private funder disappears behind an approximation.

What Luminate money proves is that it funded the organisation that owns the election-complaint infrastructure that fed complaints into the Electoral Commission during a national election year. What Luminate money does not prove is that Luminate directed any Real411 decision or chose which complaints to refer.

OpenUp is a civic-tech contractor also based in Cape Town. Luminate's own public investment register discloses USD 1,920,189 to OpenUp between 2015 and 2020¹³. OpenUp's stated function is helping government, civil society and media understand and use public data. On the strength of that capacity, OpenUp moved into direct government-facing work with the National Treasury and the Development Bank of Southern Africa (DBSA) through Municipal Money, the public-facing municipal-finance dashboard now used by 257 South African municipalities¹³. This is a textbook example of the capability-development pathway. Private philanthropic capital finances a local civil-society organisation. The organisation builds technical capability. The capability is later contracted by public institutions. That is not a claim that Luminate controls National Treasury or DBSA decisions in any way. It is a claim that foreign philanthropic capital financed institutional capacity which subsequently became useful to, and contracted by, South African public institutions.

Futurelect is the leadership-training track. Luminate publicly records USD 450,000 in total funding¹⁴ to Futurelect. Its current grant funds a programme providing intensive leadership training to 25 to 30 emerging East African leaders every year¹⁴. Luminate describes it as a pathway for building a network of younger political leaders across Africa. Historically, this exact function, training the next generation of leaders in target countries, was performed publicly and controversially by USAID and by the National Endowment for Democracy (NED). Today it is performed, in part, privately. That does not establish that Futurelect graduates act on Omidyar priorities once they hold elected office. It establishes that private capital is now inside a policy space that was previously understood as a state one.

Code for Africa, the Johannesburg-headquartered civic-technology and investigative-data federation founded by Justin Arenstein, historically identified Omidyar Network among its funders. Separately, in Mali, USAID's Civil Society and Media - Strengthened Together and Advancing in New Directions (CSM-STAND) programme has partnered with Code for Africa and Pact on media and information-environment work. Same

implementing organisation. Different countries. Different programmes. Both government and private support. This is what the phrase "public-private ecosystem" means when it is not a euphemism. It is also the frame within which Code for Africa's South African work should be read. In South Africa, Code for Africa operates the Sentinel Project and the Toxic10 threat-scoring platform, which assigns numeric threat scores to named living South Africans, including Dr Kelvin Kemm (scored 7.2) and the Institute of Race Relations (scored 6.8), deployed ahead of the 2026 Local Government Elections. It has not been documented that USAID funded either Sentinel or Toxic10. That gap is stated here explicitly because the burden of proof runs in the direction of the specific claim, not the general pattern.

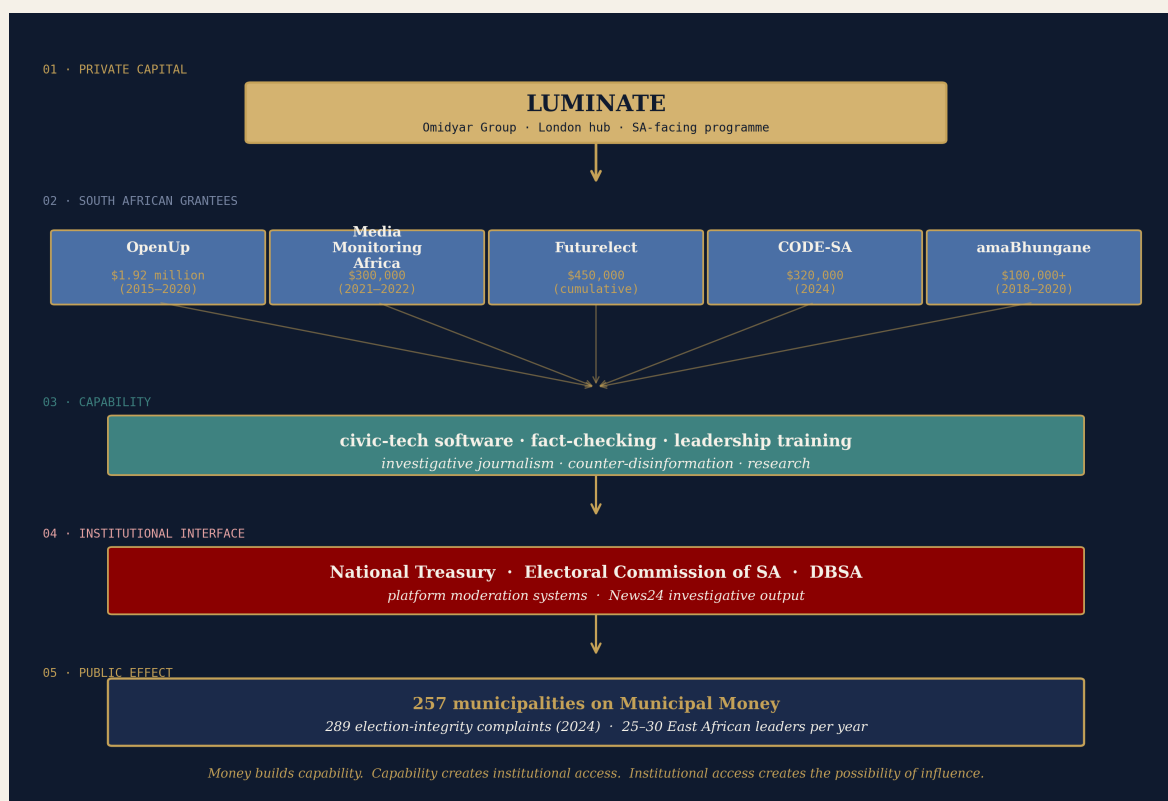
amaBhungane, the investigative-journalism unit that publishes through News24 and Daily Maverick, disclosed on its own funder-declarations page a Luminate grant of USD 100,000 or more from July 2018 to June 2020¹⁵, plus a further R659,755 rollover. Its editor-in-chief on News24, Adriaan Basson, is one of amaBhungane's co-founders. That connection matters because it means that when a South African reader reads a News24 investigation into political corruption or state capture, the newsroom apparatus underneath the by-line has been, in part, financed by London and Redwood City. That is not a criticism of the journalism itself. It is a description of the funding architecture the journalism sits inside.

CODE-SA, the Campaign on Digital Ethics South Africa, received a Luminate grant of USD 320,000 from 2024¹⁶ for work including "counter-disinformation." It is directed by Kavisha Pillay. Public confusion about CODE-SA's funding has occasionally attached it to a Nordic donor cluster. That attribution is wrong on the paper trail. CODE-SA is a Luminate grantee, which places it firmly inside the private philanthropic architecture described in this report.

Africa No Filter is a Johannesburg and New York narrative-change fund. Its funders include Ford, Rockefeller, Luminate, Comic Relief and OSF. It deploys grants to reshape how Africa is depicted in global media. That work touches, directly, how South African political developments are framed for external audiences. This report does not attempt to litigate the ideological direction of Africa No Filter's programme output. It records only that the fund exists, that Luminate is one of its named backers, and that it is one of several places where a South African political narrative meets private philanthropic capital before it reaches an international editor's desk.

Where the money becomes capability, the capability meets institutions. That is the diagram this report leaves the reader with. Capital: Luminate, Democracy Fund, Humanity United, Omidyar Network. Organisation: OpenUp, Media Monitoring Africa, Futurelect, Code for Africa, amaBhungane, CODE-SA, Africa No Filter. Capability: software, litigation, leadership training, fact-checking, investigative journalism, research, advocacy. Institutional interface: National Treasury, the Electoral Commission, the Development Bank of Southern Africa, platform moderation systems, United States federal courts. Public effect: municipal-service data, election-complaint adjudications, platform moderation outcomes, litigation outcomes, refugee-programme decisions.

Money does not equal control. Money builds capability. Capability creates institutional access. Institutional access creates the possibility of influence. That is a longer sentence than the one usually used in polemics against private philanthropy, and it is the sentence the record actually supports.



The Luminate money reaching South African civil society, becoming institutional capability, meeting Treasury, the Electoral Commission and platform moderation systems, and producing measurable public effects.

Where an old school in Maryland shows up again

Humanity United is the Omidyars' peacebuilding foundation. Pam Omidyar chairs the affiliated 501(c)(4) political-advocacy vehicle Humanity United Action (HUA), which she has chaired since it was founded. Since roughly 2005, Humanity United has been embedded, on the paper trail, in the institutional world of the Anglican Communion, and specifically the institutional world of Desmond Tutu.

The Anglican Communion is the third-largest Christian body in the world, after the Roman Catholic Church and the Orthodox Church. Its American branch is the Episcopal Church. Its Southern African province is the Anglican Church of Southern Africa. Archbishop Desmond Tutu was Anglican, in that province. Archbishop Thabo Makgoba, his successor since 2007, is Anglican, in that province. Presiding Bishop Sean Rowe of the Episcopal Church, elected in 2024, is Anglican, in the American branch. Pierre Omidyar attended St Andrew's Episcopal School in Potomac, Maryland, from Grade 9 (1980) through Grade 12 (1984). That school is formally governed within the Episcopal Diocese of Washington. Bishop Mariann Edgar Budde, the Diocesan Bishop, has publicly described St Andrew's as "such a jewel in the overall ministry of the Episcopal Diocese of Washington." The school's ex-officio Bishop's Representative on its board has been the Rev. Michele Hagans, Canon Emeritus of the Diocese of Washington. Public records show that the Omidyar Group has since donated approximately USD 625,000²¹ back to St Andrew's.

Everything in the paragraph above is a matter of public record. What it means is a separate question. The paragraph documents an educational and philanthropic tie between one of the wealthiest families in the United States and the specific American diocese which sits inside the Anglican Communion, the same Communion whose Cape Town and New York leadership publicly refused, four decades later, to help resettle Afrikaner refugees. Alt Afrikaner presents the tie as documented history, not as an explanation of current intent. Ancestry does not establish motivation. The stronger evidence in this report is institutional and financial, not

genealogical, and the reader should weight it accordingly.

There is, separately, a Diocese-of-Washington personnel corridor that runs from the same Diocese to Anglican Southern Africa. A former St Andrew's trustee, Jim Naughton, was Canon for Communications of the Episcopal Diocese of Washington. Naughton publicly documented an approximately USD 10 million grant, delivered by USAID through the President's Emergency Plan for AIDS Relief (PEPFAR), that was built through cooperation between Archbishop Njongonkulu Ndungane of the Anglican Church of Southern Africa and Bishop John Chane of the Episcopal Diocese of Washington. Old, documented, publicly celebrated. It records that the Cape-Town-to-Washington ecclesiastical corridor is not a 2025 invention. It has been carrying money since at least the George W. Bush administration.

Humanity United's own paper trail inside the Anglican-Tutu world starts in 2007. The Elders, the group of retired global leaders that Nelson Mandela launched on his eighty-ninth birthday in July 2007, listed Humanity United as a founding financial backer¹⁷ at its Johannesburg launch. Not a later donor. A named financial founder. Pam Omidyar joined the Elders' Advisory Council. She personally travelled on Elders missions with Desmond Tutu. After one such visit, the Omidyars donated USD 500,000 directly to the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) South Sudan¹⁸ refugee operation in 2012. That was direct Tutu-to-Omidyar refugee-spending influence, on the record.

Humanity United appears by name in the Desmond & Leah Tutu Legacy Foundation's 2022 annual report¹⁹ as a direct donor. Trinity Church Wall Street, one of the largest and wealthiest Episcopal institutions in the United States, appears on the same 2022 donor list. In the same 2022 window, the Anglican Theological Review, the main academic journal of the Anglican Communion, published a special issue devoted to the theological legacy of Desmond Tutu. The editors said publicly that the special issue "would not have been possible" without Pam Omidyar's personal donation. Canon C. K. Robertson, Canon to the Presiding Bishop of the Episcopal Church, was among the named editorial contributors. That is the same institutional office (Presiding Bishop) that, three years later, wrote the letter refusing to help resettle Afrikaner refugees.

Also in 2020, Pam Omidyar and Archbishop Makgoba contributed to the same Humanity United-supported Article 3 / Human Rights Day programme. Same event. Same stage.

In 2015, Humanity United and the Episcopal Church jointly signed a letter to President Barack Obama on the crisis in South Sudan. Pam Omidyar's name appeared personally on a related South Sudan policy letter alongside Episcopal bishops and Church World Service (CWS) figures. That is joint foreign-policy advocacy in her own name, alongside the same church network in which the May 2025 refusal would later occur.

The consultation, and the timing

On 14 March 2025 the United States Secretary of State, Marco Rubio, declared the Ambassador of South Africa in Washington, Ebrahim Rasool, persona non grata. Rasool returned to Cape Town on 23 March 2025²².

On 12 May 2025, fifty-nine Afrikaner refugees arrived at Dulles International Airport in Virginia, admitted under Executive Order 14204. On the same day, the Presiding Bishop of the Episcopal Church, Sean W. Rowe, wrote to Episcopal clergy announcing that the Episcopal Church would decline the federal request to help resettle them. Rowe said the church's decision had been taken "after consulting with Anglican Archbishop Thabo Makgoba of Cape Town." He cited his church's "steadfast commitment to racial justice and reconciliation" and its "historic ties with the Anglican Church of Southern Africa." He told National Public Radio the request was "unfathomable." His letter also announced that Episcopal Migration Ministries (EMM), the church's operational refugee-resettlement arm, would end its nearly forty-year federal grant partnership on 30 September 2025.

Eight weeks separated the expulsion of the South African ambassador and the transnational Anglican refusal. The consultation that produced the letter took place while Pretoria's own diplomatic voice in Washington had been silenced. Cape Town spoke through the New York pulpit at exactly the moment Cape Town's own diplomatic channel had been closed.

What the record documents is a longstanding institutional relationship between Humanity United and parts of the Anglican and Tutu ecosystem, and, separately, a Makgoba-Rowe consultation immediately preceding the Episcopal Church's decision. No causal bridge between those two facts has been established. Nobody has produced a phone log, a grant agreement, or an email. What can be said, and what this report says, is that a corridor of institutional relationships existed on the twenty-year record, and that the consultation ran through the corridor.

The record establishes a pre-existing corridor of institutional relationships through which communication was possible. It does not establish that Omidyar funding caused or shaped the May 2025 decision. The reader is left to weight the significance of the corridor for themselves.

The other Omidyar-funded organisation that ended up in the same story

Democracy Fund is the Omidyar family's principal United States-facing charitable foundation. Its work is domestic American democratic-practice grantmaking. Between 2019 and 2024, Democracy Fund paid the International Refugee Assistance Project (IRAP) approximately USD 700,000 across six consecutive years²⁴. The 2019 to 2022 filings explicitly state that the money supported "impact litigation." That phrase is the legal-industry term for a broad category of large public-interest lawsuit. In the same window, Democracy Fund paid Church World Service (CWS) approximately USD 300,000 in 2023 and 2024, and a further USD 300,000²⁴ to a joint strategic-communications platform called the Refugee Advocacy Lab (RAL), which CWS and IRAP co-lead.

CWS is a large American Christian refugee-resettlement charity. It is technically ecumenical, with member denominations including Methodists, Presbyterians, Lutherans, Reformed and others, but the Episcopal Church, that is, the American branch of the Anglican Communion, is one of its most operationally significant Covenant Members. EMM has a named representative on the CWS Faith Solidarity Team. The Anglican corridor runs directly through CWS.

The chronology of *Pacito v. Trump*, the case which has become central to the Afrikaner refugee dispute, is more complicated than a Google search sometimes suggests. On 20 January 2025 the Trump administration suspended the whole United States Refugee Admissions Program (USRAP). On 7 February 2025 it issued Executive Order 14204, creating the Afrikaner refugee preference. On 10 February 2025 CWS and IRAP, in coalition, filed *Pacito v. Trump*, challenging the broader USRAP suspension, not the Afrikaner preference specifically. In April 2026, more than a year later, the complaint was amended to challenge preferential treatment of Afrikaner refugees explicitly.

Democracy Fund funded CWS and IRAP before either the *Pacito* case or the Afrikaner-specific amendment existed. What the record proves is that one billionaire's private foundation had, in general capacity, funded both the eventual plaintiff and its eventual co-counsel for years before the lawsuit itself was filed. What the record does not prove is that Democracy Fund directed the filing of *Pacito v. Trump*, that the grants were earmarked for that case or its Afrikaner amendment, or that Pierre Omidyar personally influenced the litigation strategy. Those are the boundaries. Beyond them, there is no evidence. Inside them, the funding pattern is documented.

Alongside Democracy Fund's direct grants to the two organisations, Humanity United Action, Pam Omidyar's political-advocacy vehicle, has co-signed at least two separate congressional letters on asylum policy alongside

CWS. In one of them, IRAP was also a co-signatory. Humanity United separately funded the National Immigration Forum with approximately USD 309,000 across 2020 and 2021²⁶, and the Forum subsequently published detailed criticism of the Afrikaner refugee prioritisation. The grants preceded the criticism, so no direct causal claim is warranted, but the pattern is consistent.

The point of aggregating these strands is not to draw a conspiracy diagram. It is to describe an ecosystem that was already, well before any Afrikaner arrived at Dulles, funded, litigating, coalition-signing and federally-partnered on the specific question of refugee-programme design. When the Afrikaner question landed in 2025, the ecosystem did not have to invent a response. It had been rehearsing one for years.

Nairobi, in the same window

In the middle of the same story, a second one runs. It has nothing formally to do with Omidyar. It has everything, informally, to do with the ecosystem the Omidyar money helped to build.

On 13 November 2025, a commercial flight arrived at Oliver Reginald Tambo²⁷ International Airport in Johannesburg carrying approximately 130 Palestinian passengers, moved via Ramon Airport in Israel, through Nairobi in Kenya, and on to South Africa. The Department of Home Affairs later told Parliament that many of the passengers had arrived without departure verification, without accommodation, and without return or onward tickets. The Department of International Relations and Cooperation (DIRCO) personally intervened to admit them. The South African humanitarian organisation Gift of the Givers guaranteed their accommodation.

The aviation chain that delivered them is documented in fragments across Estonian, Israeli and Romanian corporate registers, and in reporting by industry outlets. The Israeli group Ad Kan has been publicly identified as an organiser of the wider evacuation programme. Al-Majd, a passenger-facing operator, deleted its website on 13 November 2025, the same day of the Johannesburg arrival. Talent Globus, an Estonian entity with EUR 301 in registered capital, was incorporated in July 2024 and is wholly owned by dual Israeli-Estonian national Tomer Janar Lind. The Romanian charter airline FLYYO operated the Ramon-to-Nairobi leg. KTAir, an Israeli aviation broker established in Tel Aviv in 1997 and run by directors from a single family, contracted the South African carrier Global Airways for the Nairobi-to-Johannesburg legs. FLYYO announced in early 2025 that it had entered year-long charter contracts with two of KTAir's historical sister companies. The commercial gap between the Israeli side and the African leg is small.

Approximately thirty-three days after the Johannesburg arrival, on or about 16 to 17 December 2025, South African authorities raided a United States-linked Afrikaner refugee-processing operation inside South Africa. The operation had been handling refugee applications to the United States under Executive Order 14204. The Kenyan connection is that seven of the workers arrested during the raid were Kenyan nationals working through Kenya-based Resettlement Support Centre Africa (RSC Africa)²⁸, which is operated by Church World Service. This is the same Church World Service which is documented earlier in this report as a Democracy Fund grantee and the lead plaintiff in *Pacito v. Trump*.

The observation this report offers is narrower than the accusation a reader might expect. Alt Afrikaner does not claim, and cannot on the public record claim, that the Omidyar Group, Humanity United, or Democracy Fund was operationally involved in either of the two Nairobi-connected operations. It does not claim that the treatment differential between one hundred and thirty undocumented Palestinians admitted at Oliver Reginald Tambo and the seven Kenyan CWS workers arrested was coordinated by anyone. What it observes, as a matter of the public record, is that the same broad institutional-philanthropic ecosystem which this report has documented as funding the litigation against the Afrikaner refugee preference also, historically, funds through OSF, Ford and others a network of legal-advocacy organisations whose declared programme priorities align

more readily with defending one of the two 2025 refugee populations mentioned above than with defending the other. That is an observation about which humanitarian populations that ecosystem has, in the same window, positioned itself to defend. The reader is asked to draw the conclusion the reader finds best supported by the evidence.

Is this just what Soros has been doing for thirty years?

The obvious retort to this whole investigation is that Omidyar is not a novelty. Any reader with a rough sense of the private-philanthropy landscape will point out that everything described above shows substantial functional similarity to the Open Society Foundations of George Soros, which have been financing democratic-practice, rights, governance, litigation and civil-society work at a global scale for more than thirty years.

That reader is correct in substance, and the correctness of the observation actually strengthens rather than weakens the argument of this report. Open Society is a more centralised network. It has a single board of directors, chaired since 2023 by Alex Soros²⁹. It has an executive leadership structure. Its cumulative deployment across three decades exceeds anything Omidyar has spent. Structurally, it is one very large foundation. The Omidyar architecture is federated. Sixteen independent organisations under one family umbrella. Different governance model, different formal centre of authority, different tempo of public statement, different tolerance for direct political action. Same broad field.

More important than the difference in model is that the two systems repeatedly co-fund the same initiatives. OGP's 2022 funder list carries USD 1.4 million from OSF and USD 600,000 from Luminate on the same line. OSF is a TAI Collaborative member alongside Luminate. Refugee Advocacy Lab's public funder list carries OSF and Democracy Fund together. Ford, Hewlett, MacArthur, Packard and Skoll appear on the same lists repeatedly. What the aggregate picture shows is not "Omidyar copies Soros." It shows that OSF and Omidyar are peers within a larger private-philanthropy ecosystem that also includes several other very large foundations, all of which fund overlapping downstream infrastructure.

The argument of this report is not that any one of them is uniquely dangerous. The argument is that taken together, these foundations form a major private financial substrate for transnational governance, media, advocacy and civil-society functions that governments also finance. When USAID stopped in 2025, that substrate did not blink. That is the finding.

What the record documents, and what it does not

For readers who prefer the boundaries stated in a single paragraph before they close the tab, this report documents the following. Pierre and Pam Omidyar sustain a federated philanthropic architecture spanning sixteen organisations and initiatives. That architecture has, on the public record, funded fields overlapping with USAID's traditional foreign-assistance work for the entire period during which USAID existed, and has continued to fund those fields after USAID was dismantled. It has, in at least three well-documented cases (Making All Voices Count, the Open Government Partnership, the TAI Collaborative), co-financed or participated in the same governance infrastructure alongside USAID and its European counterparts. It has, through Humanity United, been financially embedded in the Anglican and Tutu institutional ecosystem since 2005, including funding for The Elders, direct funding to the Desmond & Leah Tutu Legacy Foundation, and personal funding by Pam Omidyar of an Anglican Theological Review special issue on Tutu edited alongside a Canon to the Presiding Bishop. It has, through Democracy Fund, funded the plaintiff (CWS) and co-counsel (IRAP) in the ongoing case that now challenges the administration²⁵'s preferential treatment of Afrikaner refugees, for years before the case was filed. It has, through Luminate, funded the South African organisation that owns Real411 and the South African civic-tech contractor OpenUp whose work is now used across 257 municipalities. It has, in the same field, funded political-leadership training in East Africa, investigative journalism at News24 through amaBhungane, and narrative-change work through Africa No Filter. In November and December 2024, the same broad philanthropic ecosystem within which the Omidyar network operates positioned itself to defend one Nairobi-connected refugee population and, thirty-three days later, watched Kenyan authorities raid Church World Service workers processing another.

What the record does not document, and what this report does not claim, is that Pierre or Pam Omidyar personally directed the May 2025 Anglican refusal, that Democracy Fund's grants to CWS or IRAP were earmarked for *Pacito v. Trump* or its Afrikaner amendment, that Luminate directed any Real411 decision or any Meta moderation outcome, that the Omidyar Group was operationally involved in the Nairobi flight chain, or that any of the individuals or organisations named in this report acted unlawfully.

Infrastructure and act are two different things. Infrastructure is what the record shows. Acts are what the record does not show. Alt Afrikaner reports the first and does not invent the second.

The last observation is this. Twenty years ago, a South African journalist writing a piece like this would have had to travel to Redwood City, California with a notebook to establish a fraction of what is now publicly filed. The Democracy Fund tax returns are on ProPublica. The Luminate investee page for OpenUp names the exact grant total. The Elders' history page names Humanity United as a founding backer. The USAID Office of Inspector General wrote the report on the 2025 transfer. The Ambassador Rasool declaration is a State Department diplomatic note. The 12 May 2025 Rowe letter is on episcopalchurch.org. Real411's process disclosures are on real411.org. The Electoral Commission of South Africa's 2024 report is on elections.org.za. UK Companies House lists Jeff Alvord³ and Matthew Deakin⁴ publicly as persons with significant control over Luminate UK Services Limited. Every one of the figures above is somewhere in one of those documents.

The story was not hidden. It was distributed. That is the argument this report ends on, because it is the argument the record supports and the argument South African readers are entitled to. A private funding architecture as large as this one, financing this many organisations, in this many fields, in this many countries, cannot survive scrutiny unless the scrutiny is willing to sit down and read every one of those documents. Alt Afrikaner has sat down. This report is what the documents say.

Endnotes

1. Omidyar Group, *Our Brands* and *Our Work*, published at omidyargroup.com. Sixteen constituent organisations and initiatives, described by the Group as "independent by design." Verified June 2026.
2. Omidyar Network Fund IRS Form 990 filings for fiscal years 2022 and 2023, publicly available via ProPublica Nonprofit Explorer (EIN 20-3245700). Reported assets of USD 367.6 million.
3. Luminate, biography of Jeff Alvord, luminategroup.com/our-people/jeff-alvord-1/en, identifying him as Managing Director of the Omidyar Group. UK Companies House public records for Luminate UK Services Limited, find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk (Persons with Significant Control filings, company number 11125848).
4. United States Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) filings identifying Matthew Deakin as trustee of the Pierre M. Omidyar Trust, cross-referenced against UK Companies House Persons with Significant Control filings for Luminate UK Services Limited.
5. Omidyar Network public leadership announcement of Michele L. Jawando's promotion to Chief Executive Officer, March 2026, and updated public bio at omidyarnetwork.com.
6. USAID Office of Inspector General, *Project Announcement on the Evaluation of USAID's Transfer of Foreign Assistance Award Information to the Department of State*, documenting more than 1,000 transferred awards and approximately USD 45 billion in commitments as of 1 July 2025.
7. Making All Voices Count programme description and grants database at makingallvoicescount.org, listing USAID, DFID (later FCDO), Sida, and Omidyar Network as the four programme donors; 178 grants; twelve or more countries; 2013–2017.
8. Open Government Partnership, *2022 Annual Report and Transparency and Financial Information* page at opengovpartnership.org, showing donor breakdown for the 2022 budget. Cross-referenced against Luminate's own investment register at luminategroup.com.
9. Trust, Accountability and Inclusion (TAI) Collaborative, *What we fund* and *Introducing TAI* pages at taicollaborative.org, plus its 2024 reporting describing USAID and FCDO as observers within a donor-coordination structure that includes Luminate, Ford, Hewlett, MacArthur, OSF, Packard, Skoll and Chandler as members.
10. Luminate, *Global Strategy 2022 to 2027*, published at luminategroup.com. Direct quotations of the workstream titles and the "rules of the game" language are drawn verbatim from that public strategy document.
11. Luminate Foundation, Inc. IRS Form 990 filings for tax years 2021 and 2022 (EIN 82-3941326), disclosing grants of USD 150,000 to Media Monitoring Africa in 2021 and USD 150,000 in 2022. Cross-referenced against Media Monitoring Africa (MMA / Moxii Africa) public institutional disclosures.
12. Electoral Commission of South Africa, *2024 National and Provincial Elections Report*, at elections.org.za, documenting 289 election-related complaints processed through Real411 during the 2024 South African election period. Real411 process disclosures at real411.org.
13. Luminate investee page for OpenUp at luminategroup.com/investee/open-up, disclosing USD 1,920,189 in cumulative funding, 2015 to 2020. National Treasury and Development Bank of Southern Africa (DBSA) public documentation for the Municipal Money contract covering 257 South African municipalities.
14. Luminate investee page for Futurelect at luminategroup.com/investee/futurelect, disclosing USD 450,000 cumulative funding for a leadership programme running for 25 to 30 emerging East African political leaders annually.
15. amaBhungane, *Funder Declarations* page, disclosing a Luminate grant of USD 100,000 or more from July 2018 to June 2020, plus a further rollover of ZAR 659,755. Cross-referenced against Luminate's own investee register.
16. Luminate 2024 disclosures on CODE-SA (Campaign on Digital Ethics South Africa) direction under Kavisha Pillay, at USD 320,000; and Africa No Filter public funder acknowledgements at africanofilter.org.
17. The Elders, official history at theelders.org, listing Humanity United as a founding financial backer at the Johannesburg launch, 18 July 2007. Elders Advisory Council public listings confirming Pam Omidyar's membership.
18. United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) South Sudan Operation, publicly disclosed 2012 grant acknowledgements including the Omidyars' USD 500,000 contribution.
19. Desmond & Leah Tutu Legacy Foundation, *2022 Annual Report*, naming both Humanity United and Trinity Church Wall Street as donors. Humanity United's own grants-history page confirms the DLTF line item.
20. *Anglican Theological Review*, 2022 special issue on Desmond Tutu, editorial acknowledgements naming Pam Omidyar's personal funding as making the issue possible. Canon C. K. Robertson, Canon to the Presiding Bishop of the Episcopal Church, listed among named editorial contributors.
21. St Andrew's Episcopal School annual reports and donor-recognition disclosures, identifying the Omidyar Group's approximately USD 625,000 cumulative donation. Bishop Mariann Edgar Budde public description of St Andrew's; Rev. Michele Hagans listed as Bishop's Representative and Canon Emeritus of the Episcopal Diocese of Washington.
22. US State Department diplomatic notice of 14 March 2025; Secretary of State Marco Rubio's X (Twitter) post of 14 March 2025; Washington Post, CBS News, NPR and UPI reports of 14 and 15 March 2025; All Africa report of 23 March 2025 documenting Rasool's return to Cape Town.

23. Presiding Bishop Sean W. Rowe's letter of 12 May 2025, published verbatim at episcopalchurch.org; same-day report in Episcopal News Service; Rowe's interview on National Public Radio (NPR) Morning Edition, 13 May 2025; The Living Church news report, 15 May 2025; Associated Press wire, 12 May 2025.
24. Democracy Fund IRS Form 990 filings for tax years 2019 through 2024, via IRS and via ProPublica Nonprofit Explorer; International Refugee Assistance Project (IRAP) and Church World Service (CWS) 990 filings across the same window on the receipt side. Refugee Advocacy Lab public funder list at refugeeadvocacylab.org.
25. *Pacito v. Trump* initial complaint filed 10 February 2025 and amended complaint filed April 2026, available on the Public Access to Court Electronic Records (PACER) system. United States State Department press release of 19 January 2023 announcing Welcome Corps.
26. Humanity United Action (HUA) and Church World Service (CWS) joint congressional letters archived by Refugee Council USA; Humanity United's public grants disclosures for National Immigration Forum funding of approximately USD 309,000 across 2020 and 2021.
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28. Public reporting on the December 2025 South African authorities' raid on a United States-linked Afrikaner refugee-processing operation, and the arrest of seven Kenyan nationals working through Kenya-based Resettlement Support Centre Africa (RSC Africa), operated by Church World Service.
29. Open Society Foundations (OSF) public leadership page and 2023 announcement of Alex Soros as chair; OGP 2022 funder list confirming OSF and Luminate as co-funders on the same year's budget; TAI Collaborative member-list disclosures.
30. General Mahmud Mir-Djalali biographical material drawn from Iranian military-history archives and academic accounts of the 1921 Persian coup and the early Pahlavi military establishment. Pierre Omidyar public statements on Donald Trump, March 2016, sourced to the Center for Public Integrity; Federal Election Commission (FEC) records of the Omidyars' federal political donations since 1999.

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